1. CURRICULUM VITAE (CV / Résumé)

The Curriculum Vitae, also known as a Résumé, provides an indication of what a person has done and achieved so far in life. Its main purpose is to help a recruiter decide if an applicant is suitable for a specific role.

Structure and Main Sections:

- **Personal Information:** Name and contact details. In many countries, details such as date of birth, marital status, nationality, gender, or ethnicity are considered obsolete to prevent discrimination.

  > **Obsolete** = Fuori uso / Superato

- **Education:** Details of schools or institutions attended and qualifications obtained.
- **Experience of Work:** Details of current or previous work, including temporary jobs, part-time work, and voluntary work. Work experiences should be listed starting with the most recent job first (reverse chronological order).

  > **Work experience** = Esperienza lavorativa

  > **Most recent** = Più recente

- **Personal Skills and Competences:** Information about skills such as speaking foreign languages, holding a driving licence, and IT skills (e.g., software packages you are competent with). Hobbies and leisure interests should also be mentioned.

  > **Driving licence** = Patente di guida

  > **Leisure interests** = Interessi nel tempo libero

- **Additional Information:** References, which are the names, addresses, and positions of two people (e.g., a previous employer or a teacher) who know the candidate well and agree to provide a confidential evaluation of their character and ability.

  > **References** = Referenze

Guidelines for Writing a Good CV:

- Use a clear layout that is easy to read, such as the official Europass CV format.
- Keep a summary version that fits on just one page.
- Adapt the CV to the requirements mentioned in the job advertisement, emphasizing relevant details and omitting unnecessary information.

  > **To emphasize** = Sottolineare / Evidenziare

- Check the CV carefully for grammar or spelling mistakes before sending it.

2. HARD SKILLS AND SOFT SKILLS

Job skills are divided into two main categories:

- **Hard Skills:** These are technical skills that you learn through formal education or on-the-job training. They include skills and qualifications specific to a particular occupation.
  - **Examples:** Using 2D and 3D CAD programs, designing machine parts, repairing engines, coding, or managing databases.
- **Soft Skills:** These are personal traits that define who you are and how you work with others. They can be used in any occupation.
  - **Examples:** Paying attention to details, working under pressure, communicating effectively, showing initiative, and being a good team player.

> **Team player** = Persona capace di lavorare in gruppo

> **To show initiative** = Mostrare iniziativa

21st Century Skills:

21st-century skills are a set of soft skills needed to succeed in a career and remain competitive in a rapidly evolving job market. They are grouped into three categories:

1. Learning Skills (The 4 Cs):

- **Critical thinking:** Developing personal opinions.
- **Creativity:** Thinking outside the box.
- **Collaboration:** Working with others.
- **Communication:** Talking to others.

2. Literacy Skills:

- **Information literacy:** Understanding facts, figures, and data.
- **Media literacy:** Understanding methods of publishing information and evaluating accuracy.
- **Technology literacy:** Understanding the technologies of the Information Age.

3. Life Skills:

- **Flexibility:** Deviating from plans as needed.
- **Leadership:** Motivating a team to achieve a goal.
- **Initiative:** Starting projects and plans on one's own.
- **Productivity:** Maintaining efficiency.
- **Social skills:** Meeting and networking with others for mutual benefit.

3. COVER LETTER

A Cover Letter (or cover email) accompanies a CV when applying for a job. Its purpose is to introduce you to the employer and explain specifically why you are suitable for the role. If it is unconvincing, the employer may not even read the CV.

Structure of a Cover Letter:

- **Greeting / Salutation:** Use Dear Mr/Ms [Surname] when the name of the recipient is known. Use Dear Sir/Madam or To whom it may concern if the recipient is unknown.
- **Opening Paragraph:** State the job you are applying for, how you found out about the vacancy, and your general qualifications.

  > **Vacancy** = Posizione lavorativa aperta / Vacante

- **Middle Paragraph(s):** Provide more details on why you are particularly suitable for the position. Refer to the CV without simply repeating it, expanding on qualifications and showing how your background matches the job requirements.
- **Final Paragraph:** Express your willingness to attend an interview, offer to supply further information, and conclude by stating that you look forward to receiving a reply.
- **Sign-off:** Use Yours sincerely if you addressed the person by name. Use Yours faithfully if you started with Dear Sir/Madam.

Useful Expressions:

> **I would like to apply for the position of...** = Vorrei presentarmi/candidarmi per la posizione di...

> **I am writing in response to your recent advertisement...** = Le scrivo in risposta al vostro recente annuncio...

> **I am confident that my qualifications make me a suitable candidate...** = Sono convinto/a che le mie qualifiche mi rendano un candidato adatto...

> **I have enclosed a copy of my CV.** = Ho allegato una copia del mio CV.

> **I look forward to hearing from you.** = Resto in attesa di una Sua risposta.

4. JOB INTERVIEWS

The interview process aims to find out if you have the necessary skills and experience to do the job well, and whether you will fit into the working environment. Your goal is to show yourself in the most positive light without deceiving the employer by telling lies.

Nowadays, traditional face-to-face interviews are often replaced in initial stages by video interviews or automated on-demand video interviews analyzed by AI.

Dos and Don'ts for the Interview:

DOs:

- Find out information about the company before the interview (failure to do so indicates a lack of interest).
- Make frequent eye contact with the interviewer to show self-confidence and a desire to communicate.
- Prepare questions to ask at the interview.

DON'Ts:

- Don't answer questions with a simple 'yes' or 'no' (it gives the impression that you are difficult or uncooperative).
- Don't enquire about salary, vacations, and bonuses in the initial interview.
- Don't sit with crossed arms or cover your mouth (it makes you appear defensive or dishonest).
- Don't make derogatory remarks about previous employers.
- Don't try to dominate the conversation.

5. ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY

Job advert / advertisement:	Annuncio di lavoro
Apply for a job:	Candidarsi per un lavoro
Applicant:	Candidato / Richiedente
Application:	Candidatura / Domanda di lavoro
Employer:	Datore di lavoro
Trainee / Apprentice:	Tirocinante / Apprendista
Traineeship / Internship / Training:	Tirocinio / Stage / Formazione
Requirements:	Requisiti
Duties / Responsibilities:	Mansioni / Responsabilità
Work shift:	Turno di lavoro
Fill in a form:	Compilare un modulo
To reinforce:	Rafforzare / Consolida (es. le proprie ragioni)
To undermine:	Indebolire / Danneggiare (es. le proprie possibilità)
To deceive:	Ingannare / Mentire
Upbeat:	Ottimista / Positivo
Commitment:	Impegno / Dedizione
To cope (under pressure):	Gestire / Affrontare le difficoltà (sotto pressione)

6. POSSIBLE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS & MODEL ANSWERS

Question: What is the difference between hard skills and soft skills?

Model Answer (EN): Hard skills are specific technical abilities learned through education or training, such as programming or machinery operation. Soft skills are personal traits, like communication and teamwork, that determine how you work with others in any job.

Italian translation: Le hard skills sono abilità tecniche specifiche apprese con lo studio o la formazione, come programmare o usare macchinari. Le soft skills sono tratti personali, come la comunicazione e il lavoro di squadra, che determinano come lavori con gli altri in qualsiasi lavoro.

Question: What key information should be included in a CV?

Model Answer (EN): A complete CV must include personal contact details, educational qualifications, relevant work experience listed in reverse chronological order, technical and personal skills, and references.

Italian translation: Un CV completo deve includere contatti personali, titoli di studio, esperienze lavorative rilevanti in ordine cronologico inverso, competenze tecniche e personali, e le referenze.

Question: What is the main purpose of a cover letter?

Model Answer (EN): The main purpose of a cover letter is to introduce yourself to an employer and explain specifically why your qualifications and experience make you a suitable candidate for the job.

Italian translation: Lo scopo principale di una lettera di presentazione è presentarsi al datore di lavoro e spiegare nello specifico perché le proprie qualifiche ed esperienze rendano candidati adatti per quel lavoro.

Question: What are some essential rules to follow during a job interview?

Model Answer (EN): You should research the company beforehand, maintain clear eye contact, and ask thoughtful questions. You must avoid short 'yes/no' answers, complaining about past employers, or asking about salary during the first meeting.

Italian translation: Bisognerebbe fare ricerche sull'azienda prima, mantenere un contatto visivo chiaro e fare domande intelligenti. Bisogna evitare risposte brevi tipo 'sì/no', lamentarsi dei vecchi datori di lavoro o chiedere dello stipendio al primo incontro.

Question: How should you answer when asked about your weaknesses in an interview?

Model Answer (EN): You should mention a real weakness that you previously struggled with, but immediately emphasize the deliberate efforts you have made to overcome and improve it.

Italian translation: Dovresti menzionare un reale punto debole con cui hai avuto difficoltà in passato, ma evidenziare subito gli sforzi concreti che hai fatto per superarlo e migliorarlo.

7. FINAL QUICK REVISION SUMMARY

- **Curriculum Vitae:** A concise document (1 page recommended) summarizing your education, work history (newest first), technical skills, and references. Keep layout clean and free of spelling errors.
- **Cover Letter:** A structured document (Opening, Middle, Closing) sent alongside the CV. It connects your skills directly to the requirements of the job advert.
- **Skills:** Hard skills are job-specific technical abilities. Soft skills are universal interpersonal traits. Essential 21st-century skills focus on the 4 Cs: Critical thinking, Creativity, Collaboration, Communication.
- **Job Interview:** Preparation is crucial. Always research the employer, show enthusiasm, maintain eye contact, and maintain a positive, professional attitude.